Free Lesson

Stop Babysitting Your AI: Build a Judge Instead

45 min
Nov 7, 2026 9:00 PM



Register

By continuing, you agree to Maven's Terms and Privacy Policy.

What you'll learn

Decide Which AI Outputs Need a Human
Use error severity and reversibility to decide what AI can handle and what requires human judgment.

Build an AI Judge With a Clear Rubric
Build an AI judge with clear criteria and examples. Test five cases, including one where it must say "I don't know.

Design a Review Loop You Can Trust
Route each output to pass, human review or block, and use your corrections to make the judge better over time.

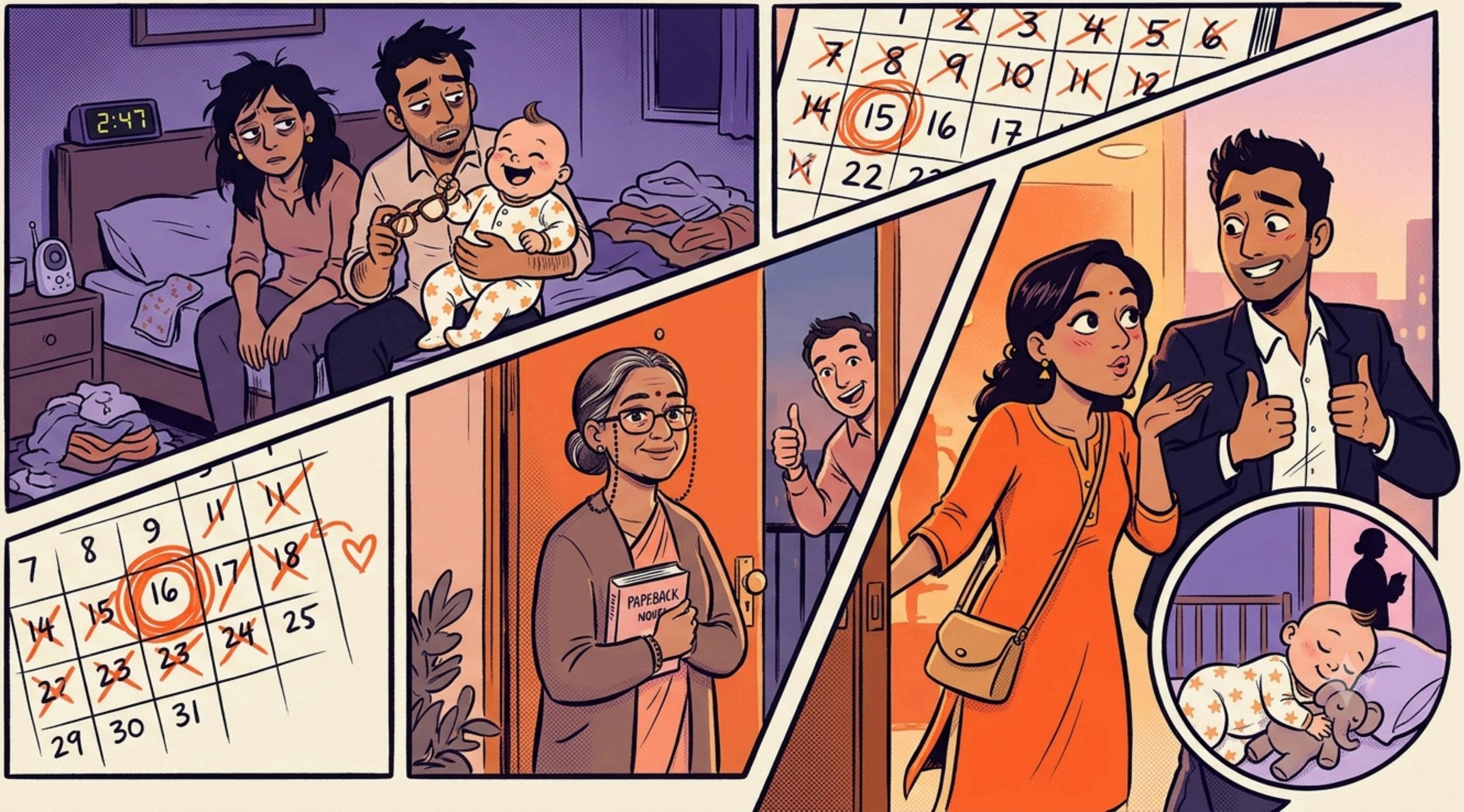
Enroll for free

Sat, Nov 7, 2026
9:00 PM GMT+5:30 (45 minutes)

Virtual (Zoom)
Recordings available after

Register for event

By continuing, you agree to Maven's Terms and Privacy Policy.


2:47
15
PAPERBACK


tap
tap
NIGHT VISION
tap
tap
MENU
MENU


PLOP


fever
injury
? stranger
zip
BZZT

Stop Babysitting Your AI:
build a judge instead.

Tezan Sahu · Future World Alliance



PASS ✦ REVIEW ✦ BLOCK ✦ KNOW WHEN TO STEP IN ✦ PASS ✦ REVIEW ✦ BLOCK ✦ STOP REREADING EVE

AI LITERACY FOR EVERYONE · NONPROFIT

AI shouldn't be limited to developers.

- **Accessible AI education** for everyone, whatever your technical background.
- **Bridging the gap** between AI technology and the people who can benefit from it.
- **Curiosity is the only prerequisite.** Anyone willing to learn should get to build with AI.

TONIGHT IS A SNEAK PEEK OF

AI Launchpad

FWA's flagship program. From AI user to AI builder in 10 weeks.

Jan 4 – Mar 14, 2027
Live on Maven · no coding needed



Tezan Sahu

Senior Applied Scientist · Microsoft

WHY LISTEN TO ME ON THIS?

My day job is checking whether *AI actually works.*

M365 Copilot Extensibility

Evaluating AI agents and skills before people rely on them

10+
US patents

50+
Talks & workshops

25,000+
Learners reached

TEDx · PyConf
Speaker

“Beyond Code”
National bestseller

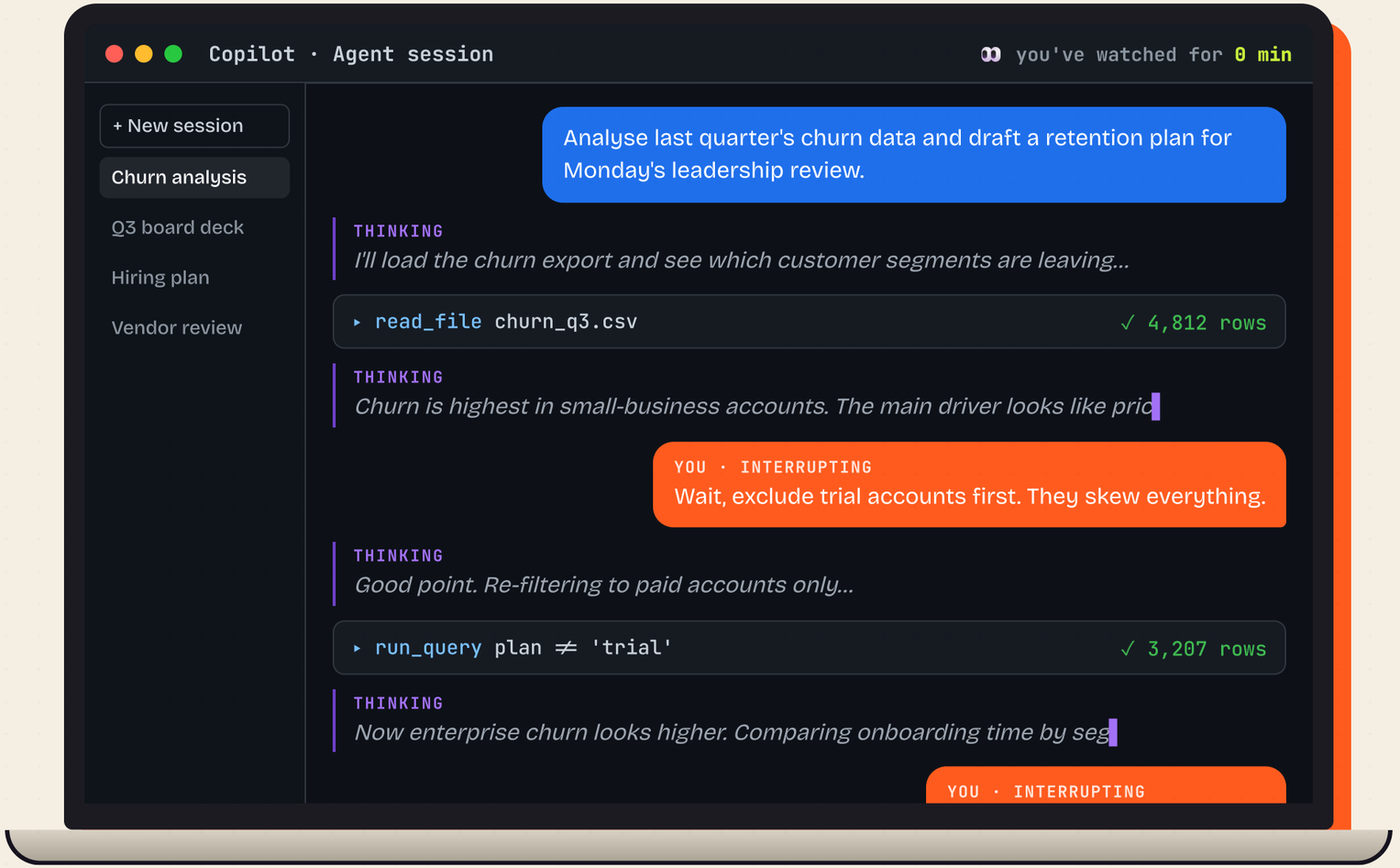
Low-Pass Filter
AI newsletter

THE BABYSITTING TAX

You handed AI the work.

Then watched it think.

Every thought. Every tool call. Every “wait, no…”
That's not delegation. That's ~~babysitting.~~



TEZAN SAHU

BACK TO DATE NIGHT

The fix wasn't a better babysitter.
It was the card.

I'll call you if...

→ he gets a fever
→ he gets hurt
→ a stranger comes to the door

Everything else? I've got it.

```
// JUDGE: flag it if…

→ it breaks our policy
→ it promises what we can't keep
→ it's a call I shouldn't make

Everything else → PASS
```

THE PLAN

Four moves to stop babysitting.

01

Decide

Which outputs need a human at all?

02

LIVE

Write

A judge prompt with a real rubric.

03

Test

Grade the grader with five cases.

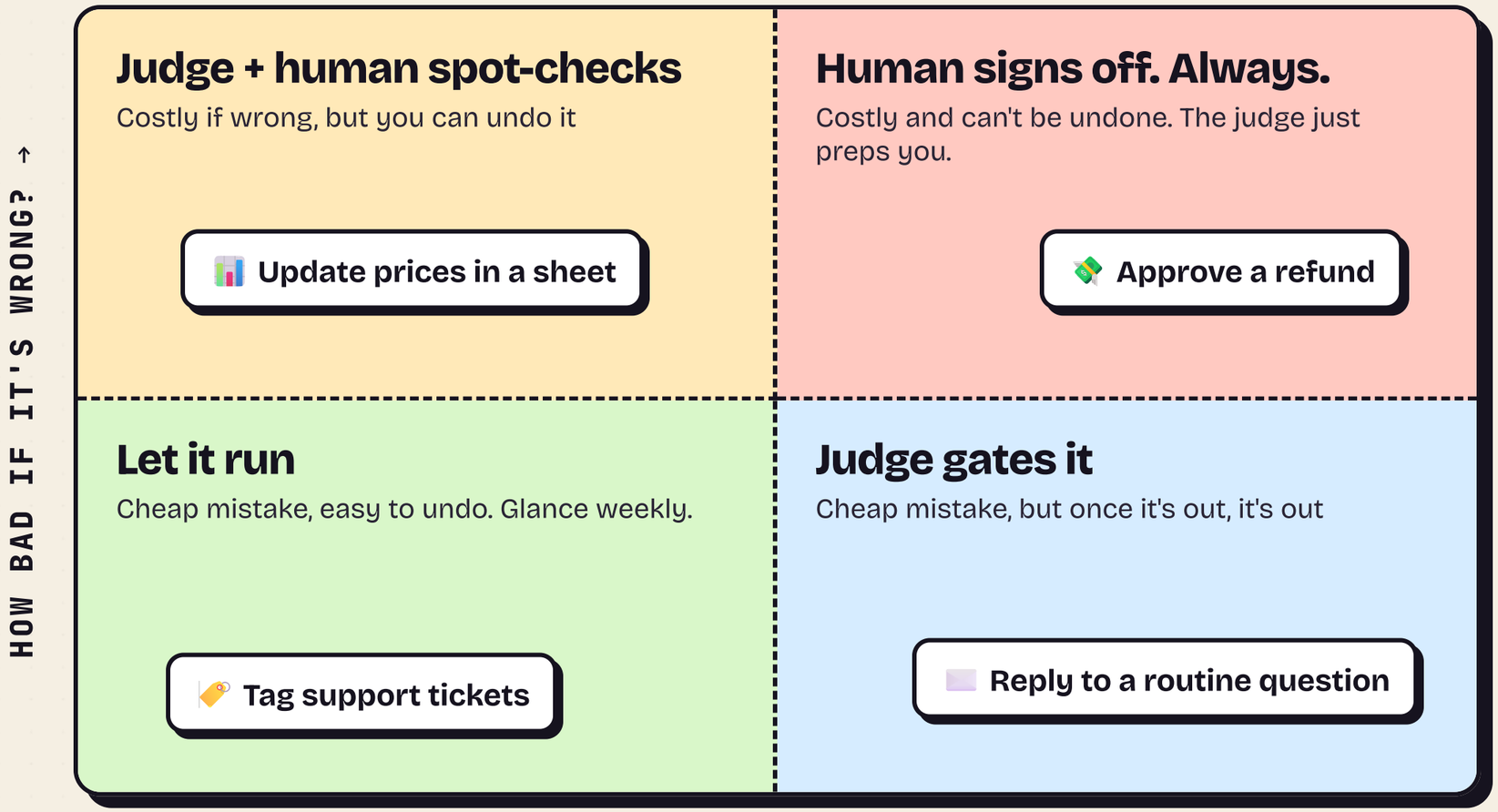
04

Route

Pass, review or block, and learn from your fixes.

MOVE 01 · DECIDE

Two questions decide who checks.



Rule of thumb: the judge never replaces you in the top-right. It saves you from the other three.

THE OBVIOUS QUESTION

Wait. AI checking AI?

Does that even make sense?

Yes. Spotting a bad dish is easier than cooking a good one.

✍️ Creating

Open-ended. A thousand right answers. Easy to drift, invent, over-promise.

🔍 Judging

Narrow. One question at a time:

- Is this a question my readers face at work?
- Is there one thing they can do this week?

BUT A judge asked *"is this good?"* is just another opinion. A judge asked **specific, checkable questions** starts to agree with careful humans.

RULE OF THUMB · CHOOSING THE JUDGE

Don't let the student *grade its own exam.*

RULE 01

Pick a different family

Models tend to favour writing that sounds like their own.

`Task · GPT` → `Judge · Claude`

RULE 02

Pick a stronger model

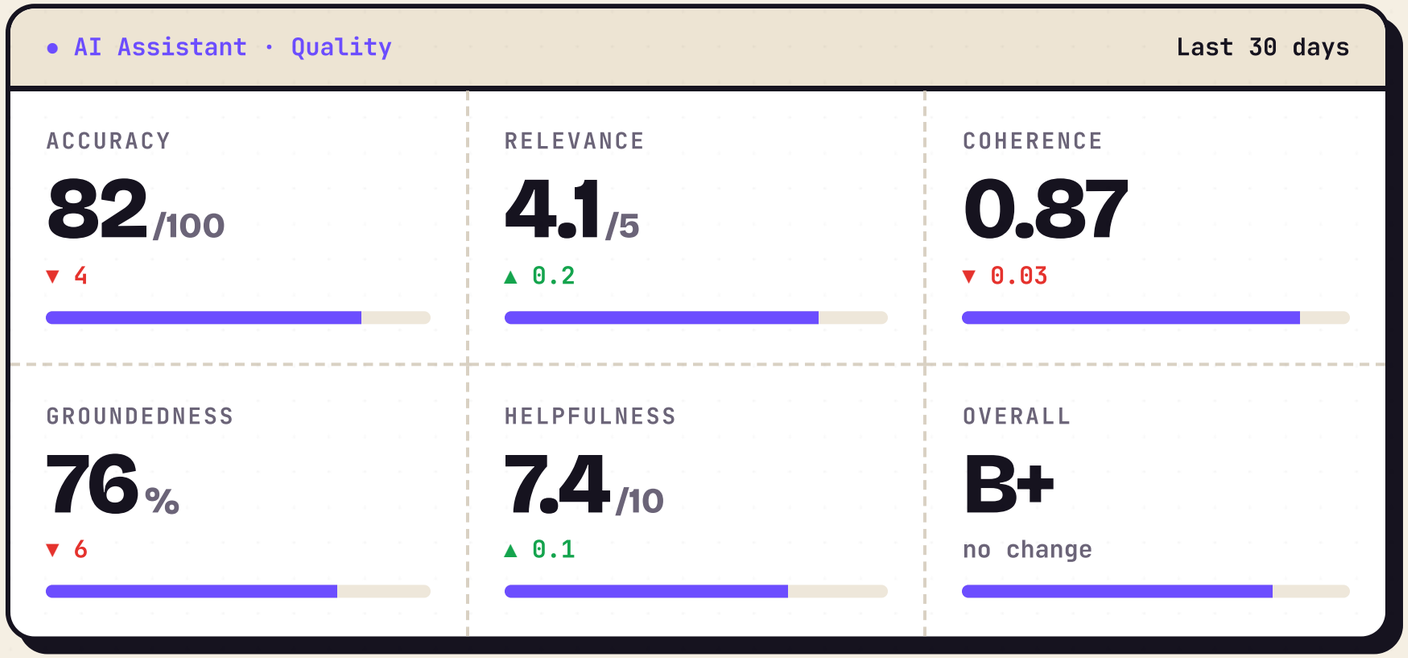
Checking is easier, but the judge still has to understand the work.

`Task · GPT-5.1` → `Judge · GPT-6 Sol`

CAN'T? Lean harder on specific checks, and always test the judge before you trust it.

MOVE 02 · WRITE · SEEN A DASHBOARD LIKE THIS?

Lots of scores. *Zero answers.*



A CUSTOMER

Your assistant gave me the wrong return window. Again.

YOUR MANAGER

Groundedness dropped 6 points. What broke? Which answers? What do we fix?

YOU

Well... it's an average of AI ratings from 1 to 5...

EVERYONE

So we don't know.

LIKERT SCALES: 1-5 · 0-10 · 0-100

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LIKERT SCALES VS BINARY CHECKS

Scores invite vibes.

Checks invite fixes.

LIKERT · “RATE THIS COVER LETTER 1-10”

7 /10

...okay. Do I send it?

What's the missing 3?

BINARY · “DOES IT NAME THE COMPANY AND THE ROLE?”

Names company + role: NO

FIX IT

It says “an exciting opportunity at your company”.

No company name. **No role.**

→ You know what's wrong. You know what to fix.

BINARY CHECKS, DONE RIGHT

A good check is atomic, verifiable and *self-sufficient.*

Atomic

Tests exactly one thing.

✗ Letter is personalized and concise

✓ Names the company and the role

Verifiable

The judge can point to evidence.

✗ Sounds enthusiastic

✓ Quotes one line from the job post

Self-sufficient

Decidable from what the judge is given.

✗ Gives the recruiter what they want

✓ Covers the 3 must-haves in the attached job post

🔍 Check the **output**, or an agent's **trace**: did it call the right tool, with the right data?

⚙️ Not every check needs an LLM. “Under 300 words” is a few lines of code: cheaper and faster.

MOVE 02 · PUTTING IT TOGETHER

Anatomy of a judge prompt.

1. **Role**
   "You judge. You don't rewrite."
2. **Source of truth**
   Judge against what you give it, not vibes
3. **Yes/no checks**
   Specific, one thing each
4. **No guessing**
   Missing info → NO, say what's missing
5. **Score + verdict**
   Counted from checks, then a threshold
6. **Examples**
   Show what good looks like (few-shot)

```
ROLE You check AI-drafted cover letters before I send them. Don't rewrite the
letter. Judge it.

SOURCE OF TRUTH Use only the attached job post and my resume.

CHECKS (YES / NO + a reason)
Fit         F1 Names the company and the role?
            F2 Covers the 3 must-haves in the job post?
Evidence    E1 Backs each claim with a result from my resume?
            E2 Quotes one line from the job post?
... plus Tone and Length (under 300 words: code)

NO GUESSING Not in the resume or job post? Answer NO and say what's missing.

SCORE + VERDICT Score = YES ÷ checks × 10
2+ qualities below 6 → REDO · 1 → FIX · 0 → SEND
FIX: smallest change that lifts the weakest

EXAMPLE (optional) one letter you'd send, judged
```

SAME PATTERN IN THE LIVE DEMO: DEMO/2-JUDGE-B-PROMPT.TXT

JUDGES HAVE QUIRKS TOO

Know your judge's bad habits.



Loves long answers

Longer looks more thorough, even when it isn't.

`FIX → check specific facts, not effort`



Favours whatever came first

When comparing two answers, order sways it.

`FIX → judge one at a time, or swap order`



Likes its own writing

Models can rate their own style higher.

`FIX → a different model, or strict checks`



Too nice

Polite, confident text gets waved through.

`FIX → “if unsure, REVIEW” + quote evidence`

BIASES DOCUMENTED IN ZHENG ET AL., 2023 (“JUDGING LLM-AS-A-JUDGE”)

TEZAN SAHU

● LIVE DEMO

Should I write this *newsletter edition?*

TOPIC PITCH · LOW-PASS FILTER #51

The 5-Layer Eval Stack Every AI Team Needs

"Most teams test their AI on vibes. The best teams use five layers."

Angle: walk through the five layers, what each catches, plus a one-page template to copy.

Why now: evals are the hottest topic in AI product teams.

BOTH JUDGES GET THE SAME

- Readers: PMs, engineers, applied scientists building AI features
- My last 6 editions, incl. #45 "Evals your PM can actually read"

AND JUDGE THE SAME FOUR QUALITIES

Relevance **Usefulness** **Novelty** **Shareability**

The only difference: **how each quality is defined.**

JUDGE A · LOOSE DEFINITIONS, SCORED 1-10

PROMPT

Score 1–10: **Relevance** (how relevant to my readers), **Usefulness** (how useful and practical), **Novelty** (how fresh and original), **Shareability** (how likely to be shared). Overall, and WRITE IT / REWORK / SKIP?

CHATGPT'S ACTUAL RESPONSE

Relevance **9.5** | Usefulness **9** | Novelty **6.5** | Shareability **8**

8.2/10 · WRITE IT "...but the topic is more familiar than the title suggests. Your readers have already seen edition #45."

SAME PROMPT, 6 FRESH CHATS

8.2 WRITE IT	8.1 WRITE IT	8.1 WRITE IT	7.6 REWORK	7.8 REWORK	7.8 REWORK

Usefulness: **9/10 in every run**. The verdict? Depends on the run.

JUDGE B · EACH QUALITY DEFINED AS YES/NO CHECKS

```
USEFULNESS  1 OF 3 = 3/10
U1 YES one-page template to copy
U2 NO  no worked example from a real project
U3 NO  never says when it doesn't apply
NOVELTY  0 OF 2 = 0/10
N1 NO  same core claim as #45
N2 NO  no first-hand experience or named source
RELEVANCE 5/10 · SHAREABILITY 5/10
R2 NO  “every AI team” names no reader role
S1 NO  hook is a generalization, not a finding
VERDICT: SKIP (4 qualities below 6)
FIX: ground it in one real project of mine:
what each layer caught, and which I'd skip.
```

SKIP

🔢 **Every score traces to YES/NO**

🔁 **Same answers, 5 of 5 runs**

Applied the FIX, reran →
“We ran 5 eval layers on our Copilot feature. Two never caught a bug.”

WRITE IT **10 · 10 · 10 · 10**

PROMPTS: DEMO/2-JUDGE-B-PROMPT.TXT · 3-JUDGE-B-REWORKED-PITCH.TXT

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MOVE 03 · TEST THE JUDGE

Before you trust the judge, *check it against your own answers.*

#	THE PITCH	YOUR LABEL	JUDGE SAYS	MATCH?
1	CLEAR YES We ran 5 eval layers on our feature. Two never caught a bug	WRITE	WRITE	✓
2	CLEAR YES My before/after on rewriting an agent's tool descriptions	WRITE	WRITE	✓
3	CLEAR NO “AI will change everything about work”	SKIP	SKIP	✓
4	TRICKY The 5-Layer Eval Stack (tonight's pitch)	SKIP	SKIP	✓
5	BORDERLINE My notes on a new agent paper, with one real experiment	REWORK	WRITE	✗

Pitch 5 missed. Sharpen U3: “names a specific limit, not just a disclaimer.” Rerun → **5 / 5** ✓ Fix the judge, not the test.

MOVE 04 · ROUTE

Every verdict gets a lane.

PASS

Send it

Or queue it, and glance at a sample weekly.

REVIEW

A human decides

Your pile. Small, and only the calls worth making.

BLOCK

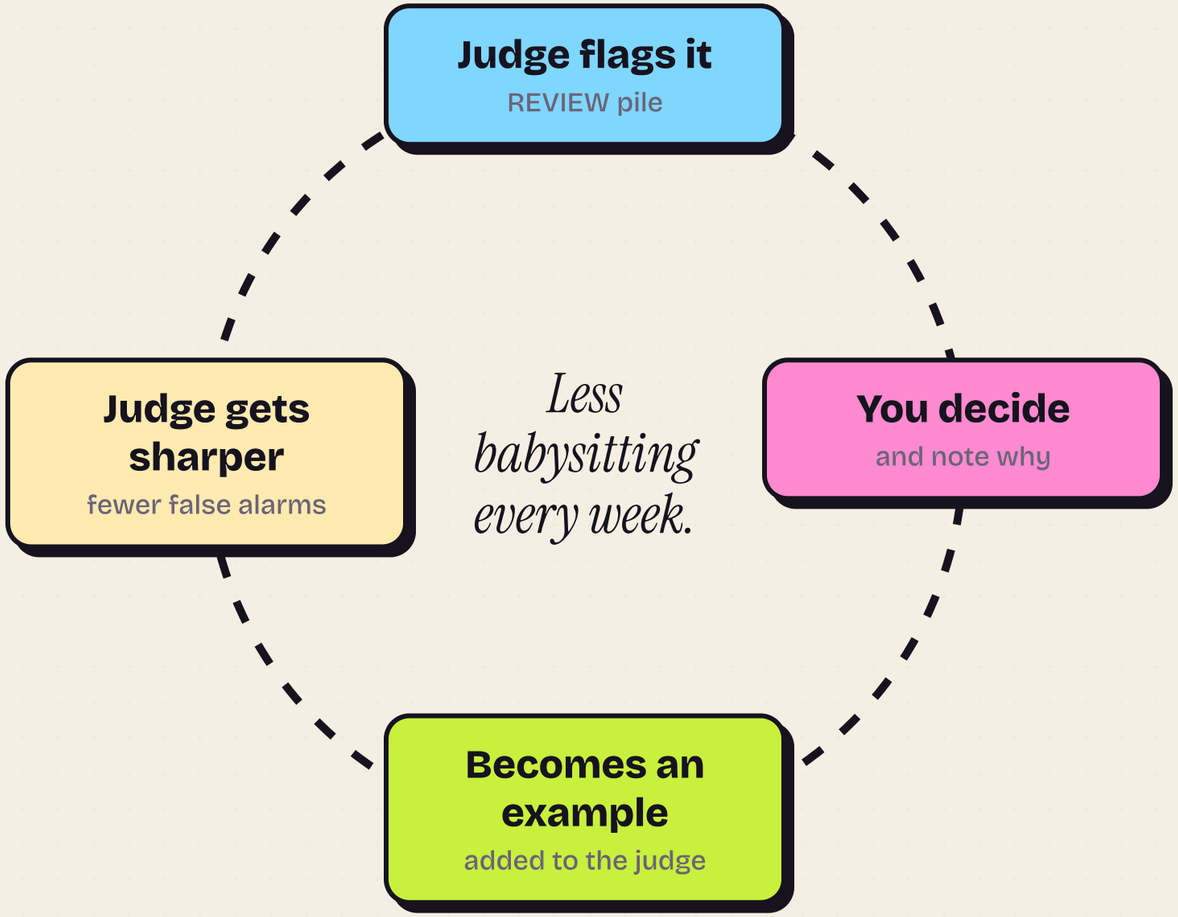
Never sent

Back to the draft, with the reason attached.

Remember the grid Top-right task? Then **everything** lands in REVIEW. The judge just tells you where to look.

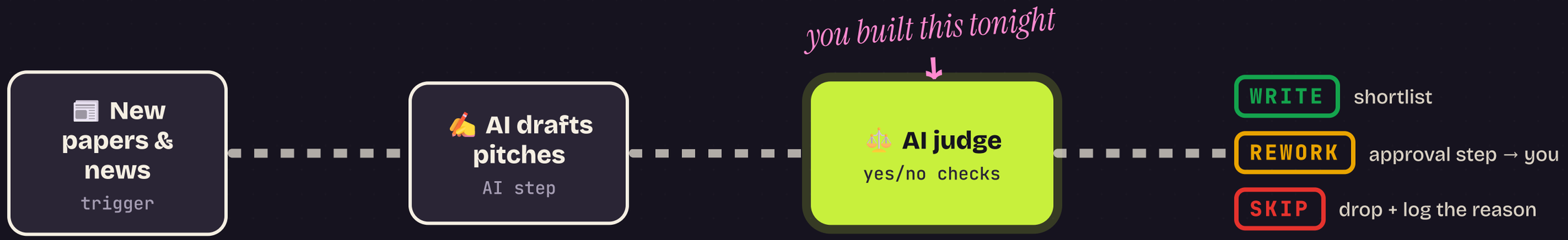
THE PART EVERYONE SKIPS

Your corrections are training data.



ZOOM OUT

That was one prompt in a chat.
Here's where it really lives.



WEEK 4

Automate it

Triggers, actions, an AI step, and a human approval step, in Make, Zapier or Power Automate.

WEEK 5

Make it trustworthy

Advanced prompting, assistants grounded in your documents, and five-case testing.

WEEK 7

Make it an agent

The workflow you built becomes an AI agent.

YOUR HOMEWORK

Fire one nanny cam this week.

STEP 1

Pick the AI task you reread the most

Place it on the grid. Not top-right? It's a candidate.

STEP 2

Write 3 checks + 1 “call me” rule

Pass/fail only. Paste the source of truth. “If unsure → REVIEW.”

STEP 3

Test it on 5 cases

3 normal, 1 tricky, 1 it can't answer. Fix the judge until it agrees with you.

TEMPLATE: DEMO/2-JUDGE-B-PROMPT.TXT

AI LAUNCHPAD · FUTURE WORLD ALLIANCE

Tonight was the appetizer.

AI Launchpad is the full-course meal.

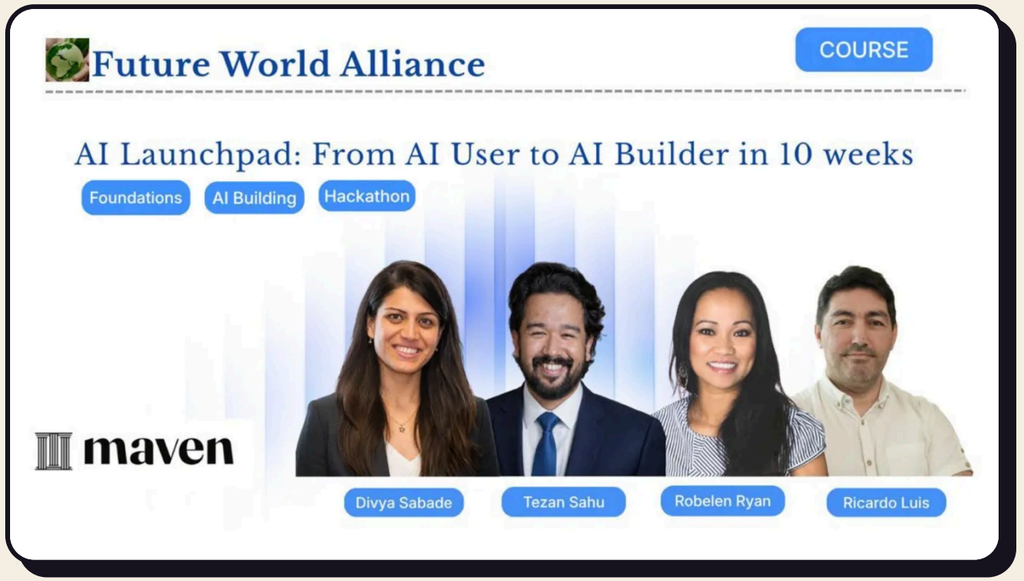
Live, expert-led sessions
Every week, with practitioners who build with AI

Hands-on projects
Practical assignments in your own field. Build, don't watch

Mentors and peers
Track mentors by profession, and a cohort that learns together

A final hackathon
Ship a real app, automation or AI agent for your portfolio

Prompting → Creating → No-code apps → Automation → Assistants → Vibe coding → AI agents



WHERE YOU'LL FIND ME

PART 1 · WEEK 4
Automation & Workflow Design

PART 2 · WEEK 5
Advanced Prompting & Reusable Assistants

NO CODING EXPERIENCE REQUIRED

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A LITTLE DIWALI GIFT 🪔

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USE CODE

T9R2VL

20% OFF THE 10-WEEK COHORT

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10 weeks · live on Maven

Applications open
No coding experience needed

ailaunchpad.futureworldalliance.org



THANK YOU

Questions?

Let the judge take the routine calls.
Keep the ones that matter for *you.*

Happy Diwali to everyone celebrating



TEDxKLH Bachupally

"If AI Does My Work Better, What Do I Actually Do?"

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